

The Purposes of Different Texts

Texts have different purposes

- 1) There are **four** main kinds of text you could come across:
 - **explanatory** — for example, an article about craft workshops
 - **descriptive** — for example, a review of a holiday camp
 - **instructive** — for example, a recipe for cupcakes
 - **persuasive** — for example, an advert for new trainers
- 2) Each kind of text has a different **purpose**.

Explanatory writing tells you about something

- 1) Explanatory texts give the reader lots of **information**.
- 2) They are full of **facts**. **Facts** are statements that can be proved to be **true**.
- 3) They often use **technical language** too.

The Mini first went on sale in 1959. It soon became the best selling car in Europe. Over five million of them were made and many famous people, including 'The Beatles', bought them. Since 1959, the Mini has evolved. It now has an infotainment system and park assist technology.

This example contains lots of facts like dates.

'infotainment system' and 'park assist' are technical terms to do with the features of the car.

Instructive writing tells you how to do something

- 1) Instructive texts give the reader **instructions** to follow.
- 2) They are usually split up into **numbered lists** or **bullet points**.
- 3) They usually use **clear language** to make them easy to understand.

See p.17 for more on numbered lists and bullet points.

- If you hear the fire alarm, stop what you are doing.
- Make your way safely to the nearest exit.
- Leave all of your belongings behind.

Simple language makes instructions straightforward.

Each instruction has a separate bullet point.

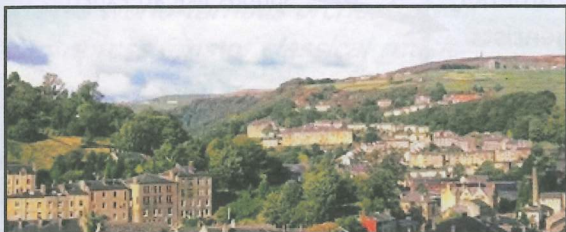
Practice Questions

Read the text below, and then answer the questions underneath.

Shopping Company Creates New Jobs

It was announced yesterday that the home shopping company Goldson's Total Merchandise (GTM) is to open a new branch in Harsham. The company will open its new site on St. Peters Road in August of next year. It will employ 150 staff to run a brand new call centre and warehouse.

GTM's Managing Director, Lucy Nuttley, said, "We are delighted to have finally tied up the loose ends on this arrangement. This is an exciting development for us as a company and for the Harsham area."



Building work on the site will start immediately. GTM plans to refurbish the offices that already exist on the site, but an entirely new warehouse will be built.

GTM was founded in 2002. It quickly grew to be one of the leading home shopping companies in the UK, with offices in London, Birmingham and Newport.

1) What kind of business is Goldson's Total Merchandise? Circle your answer.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| a) An internet shopping company | c) A building company |
| b) A home shopping company | d) An office supplies company |

2) When was Goldson's Total Merchandise founded? Circle your answer.

- | | |
|---------|---------|
| a) 2002 | c) 2008 |
| b) 2013 | d) 2004 |

3) Name **one** place where GTM already has offices.

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4) a) Is this text explanatory or instructive?

b) How can you tell?

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Persuasive writing tries to convince the reader

- 1) Persuasive texts might use **emotive language** to make the reader **feel** a certain way.

The traffic situation in Little Urswell is a **disgrace**. Our **children** are put in **danger** every day, but the council refuse to do anything. Before long there's going to be a **tragedy**.

Words like 'disgrace', 'danger' and 'tragedy' make the reader feel angry so that they're more likely to agree with the writer. Mentioning 'children' makes this feeling stronger.

- 2) They sometimes use **facts** to persuade the reader.

Temperatures across the world have **increased by about 1°C in the last hundred years**. Governments must act to fight climate change because **scientists predict that temperatures will continue to rise**.

Facts make writing more believable. The writer sounds like an expert.

Descriptive writing tells readers what something is like

- 1) It uses **describing words** like 'dusty', 'exciting' and 'silently'.

The walk begins in a **stunning** location by a **peaceful** lake, not far from Yorley Wood. As you wander past the lake, you might see **beautiful** swans. The route is **short** but quite **steep**.

Describing words tell you what the walk is like.

- 2) Descriptive writing can also **persuade** people.

Don't watch this **terrible** film. Its **shallow** characters aren't **realistic**, and their lives were so **dull** that I fell asleep.

These describing words try to persuade the reader not to watch the film.

Practice Questions

Read the text below, and then answer the questions underneath.



The coming bank holiday weekend sees Sponfield's ever-popular music festival back in Ruskon Park once again. This year's highlights include some old favourites and plenty of new acts as well:

Saturday — THE SOUL SENSATIONS

All the way from Chicago, the Sensations cover all your favourite Motown tunes.

Sunday — HELL'S SCORPIONS

These German rockers are returning to give an unmissable heavy metal performance.

Monday — THE MORLEY ORCHESTRA

This world-famous orchestra will impress fans of classical music.



With over thirty acts from all over the world, introduced by superstar DJ Daz Darley, this is a treat not to be missed!

1) The acts performing at the festival are:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| a) All American | c) Mostly from the local area |
| b) All from London | d) From lots of different countries |

2) How many acts are playing at the festival? Circle your answer.

- | | |
|----------|----------------------|
| a) Three | c) Over thirty |
| b) Ten | d) Fewer than twelve |

3) Give **one** example of emotive language from the text.

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4) Your friend wants to see some classical music. What day should she go to the festival?

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5) a) Is this text descriptive or persuasive?

b) How can you tell?

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